



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

maunena bahubhāṣāṃ ca śauryeṇa ca bhayaṃ jayet | BRP238.050.1
yacched vāñmanasī buddhyā tāṃ yacchej jñānacakṣuṣā || 50 || BRP238.050.2
jñānam ātmā mahān yacchet taṃ yacchec chāntir ātmanaḥ | BRP238.051.1
tad etad upasāntena boddhavyaṃ śucikarmaṇā || 51 || BRP238.051.2
yogadoṣān samucchidya pañca yān kavayo viduḥ | BRP238.052.1
kāmaṃ krodhaṃ ca lobhaṃ ca bhayaṃ svapnaṃ ca pañcamam || 52 || BRP238.052.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 238: On liberation by knowledge (Chapter 238), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Brahmapurāṇa offers a potent roadmap for inner mastery, guiding you toward liberation through self-awareness. It begins by highlighting the power of transcending duality. Conquer excessive speech with silence, not merely the absence of words, but the stillness of mind that allows true understanding to blossom. Overcome fear with courage, not just physical bravery, but the unwavering conviction born from knowing your true self.

The verse then delves into a hierarchical process of internal control. It urges you to restrain your speech and mind with your intellect. This isn't about suppression, but about consciously directing your energy. The intellect, in turn, must be guided by the "eye of knowledge," that inner wisdom that distinguishes between the real and the unreal. This higher knowledge then controls the individual self (Atma), which is itself then brought under control by the Great Self (Mahat Atma). Ultimately, the Great Self is subdued by the peace of your own soul. This peace, the ultimate goal, is achieved through purity of action.

The passage concludes by identifying the five major flaws ("yogadoṣān") that hinder your spiritual progress: desire (kāma), anger (krodha), greed (lobha), fear (bhaya), and sleep (svapna). These are not merely personality quirks but powerful forces that bind you to the cycle of suffering. "Sleep" here refers not only to physical sleep, but also to the sleep of ignorance, the unconsciousness that keeps you from recognizing your true nature.

In modern life, this wisdom is profoundly relevant. We are bombarded with stimuli, constantly pulled in different directions by our desires and fears. The practice of mindful silence, even for a few minutes each day, can help you regain control of your mind. Cultivating courage, both in facing external challenges and in confronting your inner demons, is essential for growth. By diligently working to overcome these five flaws, you can unlock your inherent potential for peace and joy. Strive for purity in your actions, aligning your thoughts, words, and deeds with your highest values.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

In what small, practical way can you embody the principle of mindful silence today, allowing space for deeper self-awareness to arise?